

Dario Trujano-Ochoa

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October 2026

Research Fields

Experimental and Behavioral Economics, Information and Beliefs, Nature, Financial Education, Risk Aversion

Education

Ph.D. in Economics

University of California Santa Barbara (USA) 2019-2025
Dissertation: Three Studies in Experimental Economics, Committee: Daniel Martin (co-chair), Gary Charness (co-chair in memoriam) Erik Eyster and Ignacio Esponda.

M.Sc. in Economics

Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas (Mexico City) 2015-2017
Thesis: "Quantal Response Equilibrium in a Citizen-Candidate Experiment", Committee: Alexander Elbittar (chair), Hernan Bejarano and Luz Marina Arias

Specialty in Applied Statistics

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de Mexico (Mexico City) 2013- 2014
Instituto de Investigaciones en Matemáticas Aplicadas y en Sistemas

Bachelor of Psychology (with distinction)

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de Mexico, Facultad de Psicología (Mexico City) 2008-2013
Thesis: "La Teoría del Prospecto en la Predicción de Estrategias Mixtas en un juego 2x2", Committee: Arturo Bouzas (director), Oscar Zamora Arevalo (reviewer), Florente Lopez Rodriguez, German Palafox and Oscar Vladimir Orduna Trujillo.

References

Daniel Martin

Dissertation Chair
Associate Professor of Economics
University of California, Santa Barbara
danielmartin@ucsb.edu

Erik Eyster

Dissertation Committee
Professor of Economics
University of California, Santa Barbara
erikeyster@ucsb.edu

Marco A. Palma

Postdoctoral Supervisor
Professor of Agricultural Economics
Director, Human Behavior Laboratory
Texas A&M University
marco.palma@ag.tamu.edu

Employment

Postdoctoral Researcher

Human Behavior Lab, Texas A&M University Spring 2025-Present

Research Intern

Directorate of Financial Education and Cultural Promotion, Bank of Mexico Summer 2023
Summer Intern Research Program (PIV)

Research Assistant

Association of Supervisors of Banks of the Americas 2018-2019

Subdirector of Economic Competition Analysis

Instituto Federal de Telecomunicaciones

2018

Junior Researcher

Laboratorio Nacional de Políticas Públicas

2017-2018

Half-time Appointments.....

Head Teaching Assistant. ECON 5: Statistics for Economics (No Teaching)

University of California Santa Barbara

Winter 2024, Fall 2024

Research Assistant

Economics Department, UCSB

Professor Sevgi Yuksel

2021

Implementation and payment of an online experiment on the Base Rate Neglect effect.

Research Assistant

Economics Division, CIDE

Professor Alexander Elbittar

2016-2017

Data analysis of laboratory and field experiments

Research Assistant

Laboratory of Behavior and Adaptation, UNAM

Professor Arturo Bouzas Riaño

2012-2015

Work in the projects: Learning in Dynamic Environments and Risk Behavior: Election Models Evaluation

Publications

Effects of a Brief Childhood Financial Education Intervention in Latin America

Forthcoming in Revista de Educación Superior del Sur Global

2026

María Teresa Borja Chico, Eduardo Rocha Torres, Jessica Maricarmen Serrano Bandala, and Dario Trujano-Ochoa

Citizen Candidates in the Lab: Rules, Costs, and Positions

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics

2024

Alexander Elbittar, Andrei Gomberg, and Dario Trujano-Ochoa

Learning Your Own Risk Preferences

Journal of Risk and Uncertainty

2023

Gary Charness, Nir Chemaya, and Dario Trujano-Ochoa

The role of cognitive and personality characteristics in timely microcredit

repayment: Evidence from a survey conducted by Provident, Mexico

Ensayos Revista de Economía

2020

Coauthors: Daniel Ventosa-Santaulària, Sonia Di Giannatale, María José Roa, Alexander Elbittar, and Dario Trujano-Ochoa

Working Papers

Belief Heterogeneity and Information Acquisition When Others Make the Decision

Job Market Paper [PDF]

Does it matter who acts on information you buy? In a lab experiment, I find that when priors differ, people value information more when they make the decision themselves. This control premium is driven by non-Bayesian updating projected onto others.

High Stakes and Distractions: The Source of Cognitive Load and its Effect on Real Effort Performance

Brian A. Toney, Andreas C. Drichoutis, Marco A. Palma, and Dario Trujano-Ochoa

Healthy Food Choices in Surveys and the Field: Evidence on Messages and Menu Design

Dario Trujano-Ochoa, Marissa Lepper, Paul Feldman, and Marco Palma

Does Financial Education Work in Primary School?

With Arcelia Rodríguez Aguirre

Do Liars Prefer to Tell One Big Lie or Multiple Small Lies?

With Pablo Soto-Mota and Jareef Martuza

Replication Report of “Belief Elicitation and Behavioral Incentive Compatibility” by Danz,

Vesterlund, and Wilson (2022)

With Zeeshan Samad

The Effect of Feedback on News-Verification Demand: Experimental Evidence

With Jose Gloria

Overconfidence and Fact-Checking in the Philippines

With Jose Gloria

Teaching

Instructor.....

University of California Santa Barbara

Three different quarters

2023

Statistics for Economics (Undergraduate)

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México

Six summer workshops (12-20 hours)

2012-2017

Microeconomics: What every psychologist must know, Mathematical Statistics for psychologist, Introduction to Game Theory, Game Theory and Cooperation, Graphs with R, Introduction to R (Undergraduate).

Teaching Assistant.....

University of California Santa Barbara

Twelve quarters

2019 - 2025

Statistics for Economics, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Financial Management, History of Economic Thought, Introduction to Game Theory (Undergraduate)

Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas

Two Semesters

2017

Advanced Microeconomics (Undergraduate), Econometrics: Teaching Assistant (PhD in Public Policy)

Guest Speaker.....

Toma de decisiones bajo incertidumbre

Museo Interactivo de Economía

Diplomado en Economía del Comportamiento y sus Aplicaciones

July 2026

How much do people pay to know? A behavioral Perspective

Texas A&M University

Research Methodology

April 2026

Willingness to Pay for Information: Experimental Evidence

Texas A&M University

Food Economics and Policy

October 2025

¿Cuánto pagar por descubrir?

UNAM

Facultad de Psicología

September 2024

Unidad de Desarrollo de Materiales de Enseñanza y Apropiación Tecnológica

Presentations at Conferences and Seminars

Information Acquisition When Others Make the Decision

Los Angeles, CA

Economic Science Association

July 2026

World Meeting

Can Financial Education Work in Primary School?

Los Angeles, CA

Economic Science Association

July 2026

World Meeting

Do we know the value of information?

Dearborn, MI

Society for the Advancement of Behavioral Economics

June 2026

SABE Annual Conference

Willingness to Verify News Headlines: Experimental Evidence from Mexico **Dearborn, MI**

Society for the Advancement of Behavioral Economics

June 2026

SABE Annual Conference

The Effect of Feedback on News-Verification Demand

Baylor University, TX

Texas Experimental Association Symposium

April 2025

Behavioral Biases on Misinformation

Economic Science Association

North American Meeting

Columbus, OH

October 2024

¿Cuándo verificamos las noticias?

Facultad de Economía, UNAM

Seminario de Investigación en Ciencias del Comportamiento

México City

September 2024

Do Others Learn Like Me? Higher Order Willingness to Pay for Information

Caltech

Post-School Behavioral/Experimental Workshop

Pasadena, CA

June 2024

Do Others Believe the Same? Experimental Analysis of Higher-Order Learning and WTP for Information

Economic Science Association

North American Meeting

Charlotte, NC

October 2023

Learning your own risk aversion

Economic Science Association

North American Meeting

Santa Barbara, CA

October 2022

Training / Summer Schools

14th BESLAB Experimental Economics Summer School in Macroeconomics

Technische Universität Berlin, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, and Joachim Herz Stiftung

Berlin, Germany

June 2022

Fellowships and Academic Honors

CONAHCYT Scholarship Program for Graduate Studies Abroad

Consejo Nacional de Humanidades, Ciencias y Tecnologías

2024

Short-Term Research Stay

Alianza MX, University of California

2024

Research Quarter Fellowship

UCSB, Department of Economics

Spring 2024

Doctoral Student Travel Grant

UCSB, Academic Senate

2023, 2024

Research Funding for Experiments

UCSB, Department of Economics

2023

Fulbright-Garcia Robles

Fulbright Fellowship

2019-2021

Distinction: Microeconomics Preliminary Exam

UCSB

2020

CONACYT Postgraduate Scholarship

Consejo Nacional de Ciencia y Tecnología

2015-2017

Service and Memberships

Reviewer for: *Judgment and Decision Making, Heliyon, Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics, Economics Letters, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal of Risk and Uncertainty.*

Mentor: Undergraduate Student Research

Instructor for Econ 199A, UCSB.

Spring 2024

Mentor: First-year PhD Student

Mentorship program at UCSB Department of Economics.

2020-2024

Organizer: Mentorship Program at UCSB Department of Economics

Organizing and coordinating the mentorship matching and job market talks.

2021

Member of the Economic Science Association

2021-2026

Member of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association

2025

Languages

Spanish: Native

English: Fluent

Portuguese: Learning

Programming

R: R studio, tidyverse, ggplot2, tidy models - recipes (for Machine Learning)

Experiments: Otree, Qualtrics, Prolific

Sufficient Knowledge: STATA, MatLab,
Julia, Gretl

Basic Knowledge: Java, Python, HTML